

SHAHNAMEH TD

README 03 — ETHICAL MONETIZATION AND BUSINESS ROADMAP

Build Revenue by Creating Trust, Not Frustration

1. BUSINESS PRINCIPLE

A successful game earns money because players value it.

The store should communicate:

This game respects my time.
The battle is fair.
The art is special.
I understand what I am buying.
Spending supports the game.
I do not need to pay to win.

The game must never create artificial pain merely to sell the cure.

2. RECOMMENDED MODEL

Use a fair **free-to-start** model.

Core structure:

- free access to the early game
- strong playable Khan 1 experience
- fair campaign progression
- optional cosmetics
- Founder's Supporter Pack
- permanent ad-removal purchase
- limited optional rewarded ads only after testing
- future authored expansions after demand is proven

Do not launch with a complex battle pass, subscription, or large live-service economy.

3. WHAT TO SELL

3.1 Founder's Supporter Pack

A simple launch pack can include:

- permanent ad removal
- exclusive cosmetic profile banner
- cosmetic Rostam skin
- cosmetic tower-skin set
- soundtrack sampler or digital-art gallery access if available
- supporter badge
- no combat power

Suggested test range:

USD 6.99–12.99 equivalent

Test regional pricing thoughtfully.

3.2 Permanent ad removal

Offer a clear one-time purchase.

Suggested test range:

USD 2.99–5.99 equivalent

This purchase should remove optional ad prompts where appropriate without removing earned gameplay rewards.

3.3 Cosmetic bundles

Examples:

- Nowruz Garden tower set
- Damavand bronze-and-snow tower set
- Rakhsh companion visual set
- illuminated-manuscript HUD theme
- Sacred Fire effect variations
- gate-skin collection
- hero portrait frames
- profile banners

- projectile-effect variations

Suggested test ranges:

Product	Test range
small cosmetic item	USD 0.99–2.99
focused cosmetic bundle	USD 3.99–7.99
premium themed collection	USD 7.99–14.99

Cosmetics must remain visually clear during gameplay.

3.4 Authored expansion

After the base game proves demand, sell meaningful new content:

- new heroic tale
- new map set
- new boss sequence
- new hero
- new cards and relics
- new music and loading art

Suggested test range:

USD 4.99–12.99 equivalent

The expansion should feel like a real chapter, not a fragment cut from launch content.

4. OPTIONAL REWARDED ADS

Rewarded ads must be:

- optional
- clearly described before activation
- limited
- never shown automatically during battle
- never required to progress
- never designed to pressure a player after an emotional defeat
- easy to disable with the ad-removal purchase

Good placements:

Placement	Reward
post-run optional bonus	modest extra non-premium reward
Daily Tale preparation	one optional reroll
collection screen	small cosmetic-preview or lore-related bonus
pre-run preparation	one limited scout option

Avoid:

- forced interstitials after every battle
- ads during combat
- repeated continue prompts
- unlimited farming
- ads that create a competitive advantage
- rewards so large that players feel punished for declining

Start without ads in internal testing. Add them only after the core loop is enjoyable.

5. WHAT NOT TO SELL

Do not sell:

- stronger towers
 - paid heroes with superior raw power
 - paid stat boosts
 - paid cleanse advantages
 - paid boss skips
 - paid difficulty removal
 - loot boxes
 - randomized paid rewards
 - confusing multi-step currency packs
 - limited-time fear-based offers
 - paid access to basic accessibility settings
 - power rewards hidden inside cosmetics
-

6. CURRENCY DESIGN

Keep the economy simple.

Recommended structure:

Currency	Purpose	Can be purchased?
Gold	temporary battle economy	no
Sacred Fire	temporary tactical anti-corruption resource	no
Farr	long-term mastery and progression	no direct purchase
Cosmetic purchase currency or direct price	cosmetic store only	optional

Prefer direct prices for cosmetics where practical.

Avoid multiple premium currencies unless there is a strong operational reason.

7. STORE PRESENTATION

The store should be calm and transparent.

Recommended tabs:

Featured
Heroes
Towers
Effects
Profile
Supporter Pack
Restore Purchases

Rules:

- show the complete item
- show the price clearly
- show whether the item is cosmetic
- preview the item in context
- avoid fake discount timers
- avoid misleading rarity
- do not interrupt a battle
- provide restore-purchase support
- make support contact visible

8. BUSINESS ROADMAP

Stage 0 — Prototype

Revenue goal:

none

Build:

- Khan 1 gameplay
- replay flow
- analytics stub
- art-direction lock
- device performance

Do not add a store.

Stage 1 — Closed alpha

Revenue goal:

none

Test:

- tutorial completion
- corruption understanding
- replay behavior
- tower readability
- boss fairness
- device stability

Stage 2 — Closed beta

Add:

- mock store UI
- cosmetic preview
- entitlement architecture
- restore-purchase flow
- privacy inventory
- product catalog draft

Do not depend on revenue yet.

Stage 3 — Soft launch

Test:

- Founder's Supporter Pack
- ad removal
- several cosmetic items
- limited rewarded ads only if retained
- regional pricing
- store clarity
- refund and support workflow

Stage 4 — Global release

Launch with:

- a small, polished catalog
- no overwhelming storefront
- real gameplay screenshots
- clear value
- visible support
- stable purchase recovery

Stage 5 — Post-launch

Expand only when justified:

- curated cosmetic collections
- seasonal art themes
- authored content expansion
- community challenge rewards
- sustainable events

9. METRICS

Measure revenue alongside trust and player health.

Product health

- tutorial completion
- first-battle completion
- replay after victory

- replay after defeat
- Khan completion funnel
- session length
- sessions per player
- crash-free sessions
- support requests
- review sentiment

Business health

- store views
- purchase conversion
- Supporter Pack conversion
- ad-removal conversion
- cosmetic purchase distribution
- rewarded-ad opt-in
- rewarded-ad completion
- refunds
- purchase-recovery failures

Fairness health

- whether non-paying players progress normally
- whether ads feel required
- whether store prompts increase churn
- whether players complain about pay-to-win pressure
- whether cosmetics reduce battlefield clarity

10. REVENUE PLANNING

Use conservative planning.

```
gross revenue
- platform fees
- taxes where applicable
- refunds
- payment adjustments
- marketing spend
- software and service costs
- contractor costs
= operating contribution
```

Do not treat gross sales as profit.

Build three scenarios:

Scenario	Assumption
Conservative	low conversion, organic-first audience, slow catalog growth
Expected	healthy retention, modest conversion, stable updates
Upside	strong reviews, creator coverage, high replayability, expansion demand

Do not hire a large live-ops team based only on an upside scenario.

11. MARKETING POSITION

Lead with what is truly distinctive:

A hand-painted Shahnameh-inspired tower-defense roguelite where legendary heroes defend sacred regions against corruption.

Show:

- real combat
- Rostam movement
- clean tower placement
- Sacred Fire purification
- corruption transformation
- Lion boss
- Azhdaha boss
- Sorceress reveal
- Damavand finale
- manuscript-inspired UI
- Persian-inspired art direction

Avoid marketing footage that looks more impressive than the actual game.

12. BUSINESS STOP RULE

Do not add more monetization complexity when:

- players do not replay Khan 1
- tutorial completion is weak
- the game crashes frequently
- store prompts create negative feedback

- content production is already behind schedule
- the team cannot support existing products reliably

The strongest revenue strategy is still a game that players sincerely recommend.

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README 04 — DEVELOPMENT AND PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Godot 4.6 Mobile Implementation Plan

1. DEVELOPMENT PRINCIPLE

Build the smallest version that proves the game is fun.

Do not measure progress by:

- number of generated images
- number of planned heroes
- number of future modes
- size of the lore database

Measure progress by:

- touch responsiveness
 - tactical clarity
 - replay behavior
 - device stability
 - production reliability
 - ability to add content without rewriting code
-

2. RELEASE SCOPE

Minimum viable vertical slice

Include:

- Khan 1 map
- Rostam
- Rakhsh narrative moment

- Archer Tower
- Sacred Fire Tower
- Heavy Tower
- Control Tower
- corrupted jackal
- corrupted boar
- Lion boss
- Gold
- Lives
- Sacred Fire
- three corruption states plus collapse
- hijack and recovery
- five waves
- one Pardeh Break
- small Fate-card pool
- replay button
- analytics stub
- settings basics

Replayable alpha

Add:

- Khan 2 and Khan 3
- Zal or Gordafarid
- route selection
- relics
- objectives
- Forge prototype
- save service
- accessibility options
- larger-map camera prototype
- device-performance pass

Campaign beta

Add:

- maps 4–7
- remaining campaign bosses
- more Fate cards
- more relics
- collection UI
- meta progression
- localization foundation
- polished onboarding
- expanded QA

Release candidate

Add:

- Damavand Binding
 - Hunt
 - Endless
 - Daily Tale
 - small cosmetic catalog
 - purchase recovery
 - privacy disclosures
 - store assets
 - crash reporting
 - final balancing
 - release checklist
-

3. GODOT PROJECT STRUCTURE

```
res://
  assets/
    audio/
    fonts/
    maps/
    sprites/
      characters/
      enemies/
      bosses/
      towers/
      props/
      vfx/
    ui/
  autoload/
    audio_manager.gd
    analytics_service.gd
    content_registry.gd
    game_state.gd
    save_service.gd
    settings_service.gd
  data/
    cards/
    cosmetics/
    enemies/
    heroes/
    maps/
```

```
objectives/  
relics/  
towers/  
waves/  
scenes/  
  battle/  
    battle_scene.tscn  
    battle_camera.tscn  
    region_controller.tscn  
    wave_controller.tscn  
  characters/  
  enemies/  
  bosses/  
  towers/  
  ui/  
    battle_hud.tscn  
    pardeh_break.tscn  
    results_screen.tscn  
    settings_screen.tscn  
scripts/  
  combat/  
  data/  
  debug/  
  mobile/  
  navigation/  
  tests/  
shaders/  
tools/  
  asset_validator/  
  map_validator/  
  performance_overlay/
```

4. DATA-DRIVEN CONTENT

Use resources or structured data for content.

Hero data

```
hero_id  
display_name_key  
scene_path  
portrait_path  
max_hp
```

```
move_speed
basic_attack
skill_ids
tether_radius
unlock_rule
cosmetic_ids
```

Tower data

```
tower_id
display_name_key
scene_path
icon_path
cost
range
attack_rate
damage_profile
targeting_rule
upgrade_paths
status_effects
forge_tags
corruption_behavior
cosmetic_ids
```

Enemy data

```
enemy_id
scene_path
max_hp
move_speed
armor
resistances
route_behavior
attack_behavior
reward_gold
corruption_pressure
elite_modifiers
```

Wave data

```
wave_id
spawn_groups
spawn_timing
```

```
route_id
preview_tags
reward
special_event
boss_phase
```

Map data

```
map_id
tilemap_layers
routes
build_pads
regions
braziers
objectives
camera_anchors
sector_activation_rules
boss_arena
minimap_bounds
```

Fate-card data

```
card_id
title_key
description_key
art_path
rarity
tags
conditions
effect_ids
stacking_rule
```

Use stable IDs. Never make gameplay code depend on display names or filenames.

5. BATTLE SCENE HIERARCHY

```
BattleScene
  MapRoot
    TerrainTileMap
    RouteTileMap
    DecorationTileMap
```

```
CollisionTileMap
CorruptionOverlay
RegionControllers
BuildPads
InteractiveProps
UnitsRoot
  Enemies
  Heroes
  Towers
  Projectiles
VFXRoot
  WorldVFXPool
  UIWorldIndicators
Controllers
  WaveController
  EconomyController
  RegionStateController
  ObjectiveController
  BossController
  RunModifierController
Camera
  BattleCamera
  CameraAnchorController
  ThreatJumpController
CanvasLayer
  BattleHUD
  Alerts
  PauseMenu
  PardehBreak
  ResultsScreen
```

6. IMPLEMENTATION MILESTONES

Milestone 0 — Technical proof

Build:

- landscape viewport
- touch camera
- one graybox route
- one enemy
- one tower
- one projectile
- one gate

- frame-time overlay

Exit gate:

- tower placement works
- enemy follows route
- touch input feels reliable
- mid-range Android device remains stable

Milestone 1 — Khan 1 graybox

Build:

- 32 × 18 logical map
- build pads
- Gold
- Lives
- Rostam movement
- four graybox towers
- jackal
- boar
- five waves
- basic results screen

Exit gate:

- complete battle playable without art
- tower roles understandable through behavior
- one-tap replay works

Milestone 2 — Signature systems

Build:

- regional-light states
- corruption progression
- Sacred Fire
- cleanse
- tower hijack
- recovery
- alert hierarchy
- audio warnings

Exit gate:

- players notice corruption before collapse
- players understand hijack recovery
- punishment feels fair

Milestone 3 — Lion boss

Build:

- arena entry
- claw
- pounce
- roar
- hero-response window
- defeat state
- boss tutorial hints

Exit gate:

- boss changes tactics
- telegraphs are readable
- defeat reason is clear

Milestone 4 — Visual vertical slice

Integrate:

- approved Rostam
- towers
- enemies
- Lion
- woodland map
- tileset
- props
- HUD
- icons
- VFX
- audio draft

Exit gate:

- visuals improve clarity
- phone performance remains stable
- no important action is hidden by art

Milestone 5 — Roguelite foundation

Build:

- Pardeh Break
- Fate-card draft
- small card pool

- objectives
- relic prototype
- route-node prototype
- run summary
- replay analytics

Exit gate:

- replay produces a different tactical experience
- players can explain why they selected a card

Milestone 6 — Content pipeline

Build:

- content registry
- import presets
- sprite validator
- map validator
- pooled VFX
- save versioning
- debug menu
- content test scene

Exit gate:

- a new enemy can be added without rewriting battle logic
- broken atlases are caught early
- save migrations are testable

Milestone 7 — Campaign expansion

Build maps in this order:

```
Khan 2
-> Khan 3
-> Khan 4
-> Khan 5
-> Khan 6
-> Khan 7
-> Damavand Binding
```

Exit gate for each map:

- unique tactical lesson
- stable frame rate

- readable route
- clear boss
- no camera frustration
- no repeated map feeling

Milestone 8 — Release systems

Build:

- accessibility
- localization foundation
- Hunt
- Endless
- Daily Tale
- store catalog
- purchase restore
- privacy inventory
- crash reporting
- support workflow
- store page
- closed testing
- soft launch

7. MOBILE PERFORMANCE BUDGET

Establish budgets early.

Suggested starting targets:

Area	Starting budget
frame rate	stable 60 FPS on target devices where practical; offer 30 FPS fallback
active standard enemies	validate around 60–100 before increasing
simultaneous projectiles	pool and cap
active VFX	pool and prioritize
particles	keep restrained; reduce automatically on low settings
texture atlases	group by scene and asset family
large maps	TileMaps and staged sectors, not single huge bitmaps
audio	compressed mobile-friendly formats and controlled simultaneous playback

Measure on real devices. Do not tune performance only in the editor.

8. LARGE-MAP ENGINEERING

For maps 5–8:

- use layered TileMaps
- separate terrain, decoration, collision, corruption, and interaction layers
- activate only relevant sectors
- pool enemies and VFX
- use camera anchors
- implement a minimap
- add off-screen warnings
- add threat-jump navigation
- avoid long camera travel
- preserve a readable main front
- profile every new boss phase

9. SAVE SERVICE

Save:

```
save_version
player_settings
accessibility_settings
campaign_progress
unlocked_heroes
unlocked_towers
mastery
farr
relic_collection
cosmetic_entitlements
purchase_entitlements
lore_collection
daily_tale_state
analytics_consent_state
```

Rules:

- version every save
- keep migration functions
- test clean install
- test update from previous build
- test corrupted-save recovery

- never lose paid entitlements
 - keep gameplay functional offline where practical
-

10. ANALYTICS FOUNDATION

Track only useful events.

```
session_start
session_end
tutorial_step_started
tutorial_step_completed
battle_started
battle_completed
battle_failed
wave_started
wave_completed
tower_built
tower_upgraded
tower_sold
hero_moved
hero_skill_used
region_state_changed
cleanse_used
tower_hijack_started
tower_hijack_recovered
pardeh_break_opened
fate_card_selected
objective_accepted
objective_completed
replay_selected
store_viewed
product_purchased
rewarded_ad_offered
rewarded_ad_completed
```

Document every event field. Avoid unnecessary personal data.

11. QA MATRIX

Test:

Gameplay

- every tower against every enemy class
- every hero skill
- every corruption state
- hijack and recovery
- boss telegraphs
- objectives
- Fate-card combinations
- relic combinations
- Forge hybrids
- replay
- pause
- background and resume behavior

Devices

- low-memory Android
- mid-range Android
- modern Android
- target iPhone range if shipping on iOS
- varied aspect ratios
- notched screens
- touch accuracy
- battery and thermal behavior

Accessibility

- high contrast
- reduced particles
- reduced flashes
- reduced shake
- UI scale
- volume separation
- readable text
- color-safe corruption states

Store

- purchase
- cancellation
- restore
- reinstall
- offline state
- entitlement recovery
- refund handling
- privacy disclosures

- SDK inventory
-

12. FIRST PRIORITY BACKLOG

Build first:

1. project skeleton
2. data registry
3. Khan 1 graybox
4. tower placement
5. pathfinding
6. waves
7. gate integrity
8. Rostam movement
9. Gold
10. Sacred Fire
11. corruption regions
12. hijack recovery
13. Lion boss
14. Pardeh Break
15. replay
16. analytics stub
17. performance overlay
18. device testing

Build later:

1. remaining maps
 2. large collection UI
 3. Hunt
 4. Endless
 5. Daily Tale
 6. cosmetics
 7. advanced live-ops tools
 8. authored expansion
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README 05 — LAUNCH, LIVE-OPS, ANALYTICS, AND COMMUNITY

Operate Sustainably Before Attempting a Large Live Service

1. OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Launch a polished authored game with repeatable modes.

Live operations support quality. They do not replace it.

```
stable build
-> clear onboarding
-> fair monetization
-> useful analytics
-> small repeatable events
-> authored expansion
```

2. LAUNCH STAGES

Stage	Audience	Goal
internal prototype	team and trusted testers	prove controls and combat
closed alpha	invited players	validate Khan 1 replayability
closed beta	broader testers	validate progression, saves, and devices
soft launch	limited audience	validate retention, fairness, and revenue
global release	public	establish trust and momentum
post-launch	active players	sustain community and add quality content

3. SUSTAINABLE CONTENT CADENCE

Weekly

- validated Daily Tale seeds
- one weekly challenge
- bug triage
- one community post
- support review

Monthly

- one small cosmetic collection or returning curated bundle

- one community challenge
- one quality update when needed
- one accessibility review
- one balance review based on data and playtests

Quarterly or milestone-based

- one themed event
- one meaningful content update or progress report
- store-page creative refresh
- roadmap review

Do not promise weekly handcrafted maps or expensive animation sets unless the team has proven it can deliver them.

4. EVENT IDEAS

Event	Reused systems	Reward
Nowruz Sacred Garden	map modifiers and cosmetic tower set	visual collection and profile frame
Damavand Echoes	anchor-order variation and Endless modifiers	banner and lore entry
Lion's Oath	Khan 1 mastery challenge	Rakhsh-themed cosmetic
Manuscript Night	UI theme and accessibility-safe visibility modifier	cosmetic interface theme
Forge Festival	hybrid-tower challenge	Forge-themed tower skin

Events must remain playable without spending.

5. COMMUNITY STRATEGY

Share:

- real gameplay clips
- asset-to-gameplay comparisons
- tower silhouette iterations
- boss telegraph breakdowns
- art-direction notes
- accessibility improvements
- challenge runs

- respectful Shahnameh context
- player builds
- patch notes

Invite feedback from Persian-speaking players and cultural reviewers. Treat corrections respectfully.

6. ANALYTICS DASHBOARD

Product health

- daily and weekly active players
- session count
- session length
- crash-free sessions
- loading failures
- tutorial completion
- Khan completion funnel
- replay after win
- replay after defeat

Gameplay health

- tower selection
- upgrade choices
- hero usage
- Fate-card selection
- relic selection
- objective acceptance
- objective completion
- corruption-collapse causes
- hijack recovery rate
- boss failure reasons
- large-map camera-friction signals

Business health

- store views
- purchase conversion
- product revenue
- Supporter Pack conversion
- rewarded-ad opt-in
- ad-removal purchase
- refunds
- entitlement-support issues
- review sentiment

7. FIRST 90 DAYS AFTER RELEASE

Days 1–14

- monitor crashes and support daily
- fix blockers quickly
- avoid unnecessary balance swings
- track onboarding and Khan 1 funnel
- respond constructively to reviews

Days 15–30

- release quality patch
- improve tutorial friction
- refine store clarity if needed
- run one simple community challenge

Days 31–60

- add first small event
- refresh store creative with real gameplay
- evaluate Daily Tale and Endless engagement
- choose the highest-value quality improvements

Days 61–90

- publish roadmap update
- decide whether an authored expansion is justified
- release a curated cosmetic collection
- confirm sustainable update cadence

8. SUPPORT PRIORITY

Prioritize issues in this order:

1. purchase or entitlement failure
2. save loss
3. crash or progression blocker
4. severe performance regression
5. unfair balance exploit
6. cosmetic or presentation bug

Maintain:

- support contact
 - privacy contact
 - known-issues list
 - patch notes
 - save-recovery procedure
 - purchase-entitlement recovery procedure
 - rollback plan
 - ability to disable a broken offer or event where infrastructure permits
-

9. LIVE-OPS STOP RULE

Reduce scope when live operations begin harming core quality.

It is better to ship fewer excellent events than many rushed events.

The strongest growth asset is still a game that players sincerely recommend.